

Abdul Kalam Syed

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EDUCATION

Software Engineering, M.S.

September 2024 – December 2026

University of California, Irvine – Irvine, CA (GPA: 3.87)

Computer Science, B.S., Minor: Data Science

August 2020 – May 2024

California State Polytechnic University, Pomona – Pomona, CA (GPA: 3.82, Summa Cum Laude)

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer, [PaintFlow](#) – Remote | Freelance

April 2026 – Present

- Developing a **TypeScript**-based **Next.js/React** retail platform from direct business requirements, combining customer-facing web pages and staff-facing inventory, billing, and reporting workflows.
- Designed **PostgreSQL** schemas for ERP-style workflows, searchable records, PDF invoices, and scheduled reports.
- Building a responsive customer and dashboard interfaces with **Tailwind CSS** and **GSAP-powered** interactions.
- Prototyping an **AI color-preview** module using **OpenAI** image-editing APIs for interactive paint visualization.
- Leveraging **Cursor** and **Claude** for **AI-assisted development** to accelerate implementation, debugging, refactoring, and UI iteration while maintaining architecture and code quality.

Software Engineer, [F1 Fan Engagement Platform](#) – Remote | Independent Project

January 2026 – March 2026

- Built and shipped a full-stack Formula 1 fan platform supporting race predictions, driver ratings, and leaderboard tracking for **100+** active users, developed solo in two months using **GitHub Copilot** and **Codex** to accelerate delivery.
- Designed **relational database schemas** and **REST APIs** using **Supabase** and **PostgreSQL** to manage users, season-long scoring, rankings, and historical performance data.
- Engineered deterministic batch scoring logic to maintain consistent leaderboard state after each race.
- Architected reusable **Next.js/React** components and extensible data models for race-day engagement and analytics.

IT Support Specialist I, Prime Healthcare – Ontario, California | Full-time

September 2024 – Present

- Support enterprise systems across **50+ hospitals**, resolving **300+** issues weekly and increasing productivity by **10%**.
- Built an internal **HTML/CSS** dashboard linking time zones with call-tracking workflows for multi-region support.
- Perform pre-deployment validation, issue reproduction, and workflow testing to minimize production risk.

RESEARCH & PROJECTS

Graduate Research Developer, [Accessibility Analysis Plugin for Figma](#) – UC Irvine

October 2024 – June 2025

- Researched, designed, and built a real-time **Figma** plugin in **JavaScript** to extract and normalize design metadata for accessibility analysis, conducted with graduate faculty supervision.
- Implemented rule-based evaluation over Figma design **JSON** aligned with WCAG accessibility standards.
- Developed a reporting UI in **HTML/CSS** to surface accessibility violations, affected elements, and severity levels.
- Integrated the **OpenAI API** to generate **AI-assisted** fix suggestions while preserving design intent.

Backend Lead, [PennyWise.money](#) – Cal Poly Pomona

September 2023 – December 2023

- Led backend development for an expense-tracking web app, architecting **Flask REST APIs**, **SQLAlchemy ORM** models, and **Plaid API** integration for secure transaction retrieval and scalable data processing/storage.
- Developed an **NLP-based** expense categorization pipeline using **Python** and **Pandas**, reducing manual entry by **75%**.
- Deployed backend on **AWS EC2** and frontend on **Vercel** under a custom domain, managing frontend integration.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, SQL, JavaScript/TypeScript, HTML/CSS

Frameworks & Tools: Next.js, Node.js, React, Flask, Django, Supabase, Git/GitHub, Docker, PyTorch, TensorFlow

Cloud, Databases & AI: AWS (EC2, RDS), PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, ChatGPT/Codex

Core Concepts: Object-Oriented Programming, Data Structures & Algorithms, API Design, REST APIs, Agile Development